Hi, I'm Brenden 👋

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VP, Applied AI & DevEx Lead

Engineering Leader • Product Builder • Applied AI & DevEx

Husband, father, and technologist. I like building products, improving how teams work, and finding better ways to build software. Addicted to coffee and coding. Over the past 10 years I've worked across engineering, product, and systems, building client-facing platforms and products from 0->1.

Recently, I've been focused on how software gets built with AI, re-defining workflows around LLMs in real production environments. That means placing LLMs into real workflows, building internal tools and agentic systems, and creating the conditions for fast, high-confidence iteration.

Work Experience

Morgan Stanley

Applied AI & DevEx Lead, Client Platforms — 2026 – Now

- Leading adoption of AI-native development, defining how **LLMs** are used across workflows, tooling, and the **SDLC**
- Built internal tools and agentic workflows for code generation, testing, API development, and **CI/CD**, improving delivery **speed by 4×**
- Led **Nevernote** to OpenAI Hackathon finalist status using **Whisper**, **LangChain**, and **GPT**

Engineering Manager, Client Platforms — 2021 – 2026

- Led engineering strategy and delivery for **5** planning apps across Morgan Stanley Online and E*TRADE, managing **12** engineers across **3** global squads
- Influenced a modern rebuild over a legacy-first approach, launching a unified platform that merged two experiences and saved **$2M+**

Business Analyst → UI Developer → UI Development Lead — 2015 – 2021

- Led UI development for two zero-to-one financial planning applications in **Angular**, partnering with product and backend teams
- Created technical and functional requirements, workflows, and dependency plans while mentoring junior engineers and raising frontend standards

Forwheel — 2021 – Now

Founder

- Founded and built a production B2B platform from 0->1, owning product vision, architecture, and full-stack implementation
- Built AI advisor 'Garnish' with **OpenAI** and **RAG**, and launched on **iOS** and **Android** using **Flutter**, **Firebase**, and **GCP**
- Secured contracts with **3** key industry vendors for discounted goods and services

Rbitrage Capital — 2017 – 2019

Co-Founder

- Led technical strategy for algorithmic crypto trading platform using **Java**, **React**, and **AWS**
- Automated arbitrage trading and optimized exchange execution, growing AUM to **$750K** in 18 months

Skills

Languages

JavaScript, TypeScript, Dart, Python, GraphQL

Libraries & Frameworks

React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Flutter, AI SDK

Platforms & Tooling

GCP, Vercel, Convex, Postgres, Docker, PostHog, OpenAI, OpenRouter

My Projects

- Braver Search: Safari plugin for iOS/Mac that makes Brave Search the default browser with over **20k DAUs**
- Cycles MCP: AI project management tool that turns product requirements into right-sized dev tasks and handles git automation
- CiderPress: Web app using **ffmpeg wasm** to convert .mp4 videos for Apple App Store app preview compliance
- Jumblebook Notes: Encrypted note-taking app built with **Flutter** and **Dart**, deployed to iOS and Android

Education

Marist College | Bachelor's in Computer Science — 2011 – 2015